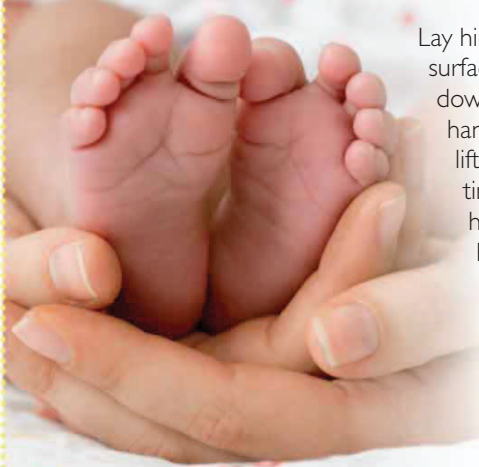


Baby aerobics

Help your baby strengthen his legs, arms, and abdominal muscles with some baby aerobics. Don't be discouraged if he doesn't seem enthusiastic at first; try again later and he may respond to your gentle touch and encouraging voice and smile by relaxing his limbs. Make sure the room is warm and try doing these gentle, minimal exercises to the rhythm of a song or nursery rhyme, such as "Baa, Baa, Black Sheep," to hold his attention and keep his gaze on you.

Lift and lower his limbs



Lay him on his back on a soft surface on the floor and kneel down in front of him. Hold his hands in yours and very gently lift and lower his hands a few times. Cup a foot in each hand—or both feet in your hands—and lift and lower his feet in the same way.

Still holding his feet, lift them off the floor a little. Gently move his feet slightly away from each other; bring them back together; and lower them to the floor. Repeat a few more times.